

Gascovid Forte Tablet

VIGAS05-var

Description

Round, 16mm, off-white to dark beige, mottled uncoated tablet, bevel-edged and flat faces.

Composition

Each tablet contains Sodium alginate 500mg, Sodium bicarbonate 267mg and Calcium carbonate 160mg.

Actions and Pharmacology

Pharmacotherapeutic classification: A02BX 13. Other drugs for peptic ulcer and gastro-oesophageal reflux disease.

On ingestion Gascovid Forte Tablet react rapidly with gastric acid to form a raft of alginic acid gel having a near neutral pH and which floats on the stomach contents, quickly and effectively impeding gastro-oesophageal reflux, for up to 4 hours. In severe cases the raft itself may be refluxed into the oesophagus, in preference to the stomach contents, and exert a demulcent effect.

Pharmacokinetics

The mode of action of Gascovid Forte Tablet is physic al and does not depend on absorption into the systemic circulation.

Indications

Relief from the pain and discomfort of heartburn and acid indigestion.

Contraindications

This medicinal product is contraindicated in patients with known or suspected hypersensitivity to the active substances or to any of the excipients.

Pregnancy and Lactation

Open controlled studies in 281 pregnant women did not demonstrate any significant adverse effects of Gascovid Forte Tablet on the course of pregnancy or on the health of the foetus or new-born child. Based on this Gascovid Forte Tablet may be used during pregnancy and lactation.

Precautions

This product contains sodium. This should be taken into account when a highly restricted salt diet is recommended, e.g. in some cases of congestive cardiac failure and renal impairment.

This product contains calcium carbonate. Care needs to be taken in treating patients with hypercalcaemia, nephrocalcinosis and recurrent calcium containing renal calculi.

There is a possibility of reduced efficacy in patients with very low levels of gastric acid.

If symptoms do not improve after seven days, the clinical situation should be reviewed.

Treatment of children younger than 12 years of age is not generally recommended, except on medical advice.

Interaction with Other Medicaments and Other Forms of Interaction

Due to the presence of calcium carbonate which act as an antacid, a time-interval of 2 hours should be considered between Gascovid Forte Tablet intake and the administration of other medicinal products, especially H2-antihistaminics tetracyclines, digoxine, fluoroquinolone, iron salt, ketoconazole, neuroleptics, thyroxine, penicilamine, beta-blockers (atenolol, metoprolol, propanolol), glucocorticoid, chloroquine, and diphosphonates.

Main Side/Adverse Effects

Very rarely (<1/10,000) patients may develop allergic manifestations such as urticaria or bronchospasm, anaphylactic or anaphylactoid reactions.

Overdose

In the event of overdosage symptomatic treatment should be given. The patient may notice abdominal distension.

Dosage and Administration

For oral administration, after being thoroughly chewed.

Adults and children 12 years and over: One to two tablets after meals and at bedtime.

Children under 12 years: Should be given only on medical advice.

Elderly: No dose modifications necessary for this age group.

Note : The information given here is limited. For further information consult your doctor or pharmacists.

Storage : Store below 30°C.

Presentation/ packing : Blister of 1 x 6's, 2 x 6's, 10 x 6's. (Not all presentation available locally).

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